



Palace Professional Network

Connecting IPC Professionals for Mentorship, Networking & Growth

PROJECT SUMMARY

International Palace Church • Mobile & Web Platform
September 2026

What This Project Is

Palace Professional Network (PPN) is a professional networking and mentorship platform built for members of the International Palace Church (IPC). It brings every working professional in the congregation into a single, searchable directory organized by profession, so members can find each other, connect for mentorship, and grow their careers within a community of people who already share their values.

Before PPN, there was no central, digital record of who does what within the church. Professional connections happened informally, through word of mouth and Sunday conversations. PPN turns that same idea into a mobile app: every member's profession, workplace, and contact details are captured once and kept up to date, and the app makes it possible to reach out directly, whether that's a young graduate looking for a mentor in law, or a business owner looking for a fellow IPC accountant.

Who It's For

- **Members** — professionals across every trade and field — from healthcare to ICT, law to skilled trades — who want to be discoverable and connect with others in their profession.
- **Mentors & mentees** — experienced professionals offering guidance, and younger or newer professionals looking for it.
- **Church leadership** — a living record of the professional skill base within the congregation, useful for outreach, referrals, and support.

The Problem It Solves

- **No central directory** — member professions and contact details lived nowhere but in individual memories.
- **Hard to find the right person** — no way to search “who in the church is a lawyer” or “who works in tech.”
- **No easy way to connect by profession** — no group space for, say, all healthcare professionals to talk to each other.

What Has Been Built

The platform is live in production today, with a real dataset of 115 church members already imported. The following features are fully implemented and working end to end, from the mobile app through to the backend and database.

1. Secure Login & Accounts

- **Phone number + PIN login** — simple, familiar sign-in — no email or password to remember.
- **Every existing member has an account** — all 115 imported members can log in immediately with a default PIN.
- **Change PIN** — a dedicated Settings tab lets any member change their PIN at any time.

2. Professional Biodata Profile

- **One profile per member** — name, age range, gender, marital status, profession, workplace, email, and profile photo.
- **Pre-filled & editable** — returning users see their existing details already filled in and can update them any time — for example, after changing jobs.
- **12 profession categories** — including sub-categories for artisans and vendors, matching how the church's professionals are naturally organized.

3. Professional Directory

- **Searchable by name or profession** — instantly find any member.
- **Browse by category** — a visual grid on the Dashboard groups the whole directory by profession — tap a category to see everyone in it.
- **Full profile view** — see a member's workplace and details, and message them directly from their profile.

4. Real-Time Chat

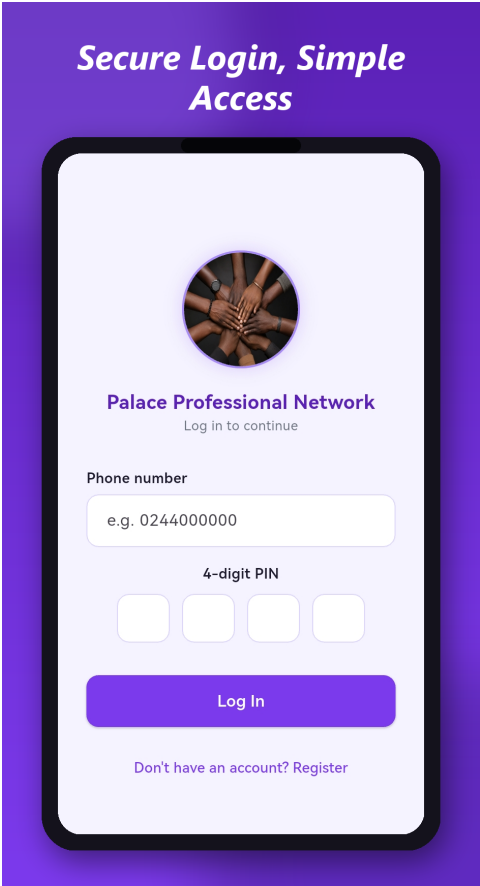
- **One-to-one messaging** — message any member directly from their directory profile.
- **Profession group chats** — every profession category has its own live group chat, automatically open to everyone in that category.
- **Built on WebSockets** — messages arrive instantly, with full history persisted so conversations are never lost.

5. Settings

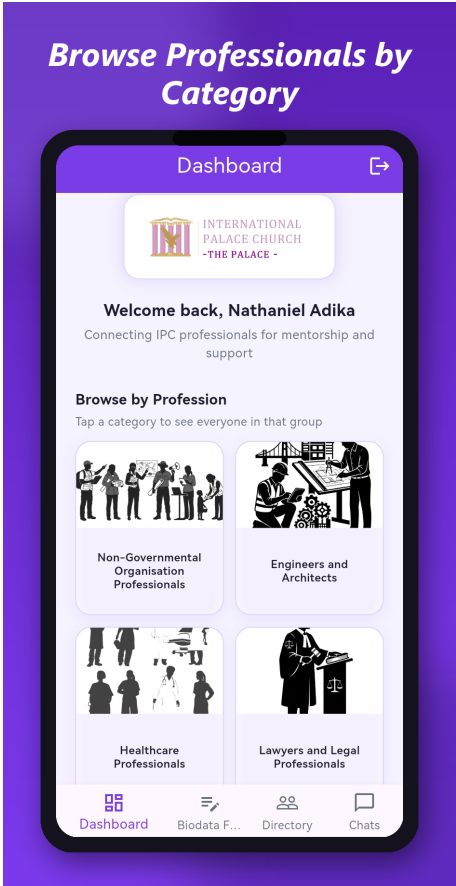
- **Change PIN** — update login PIN from a dedicated tab, without needing to contact an administrator.

App Screens

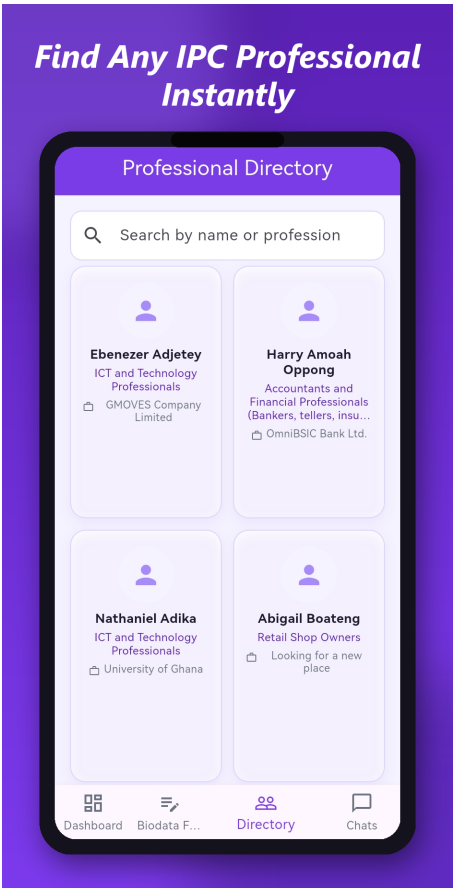
The screenshots below are from the live production app, shown on an Android device.



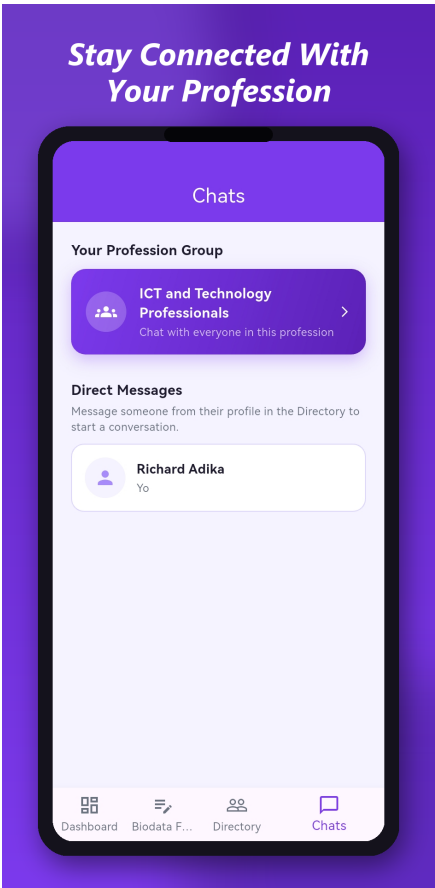
Secure phone number + PIN login



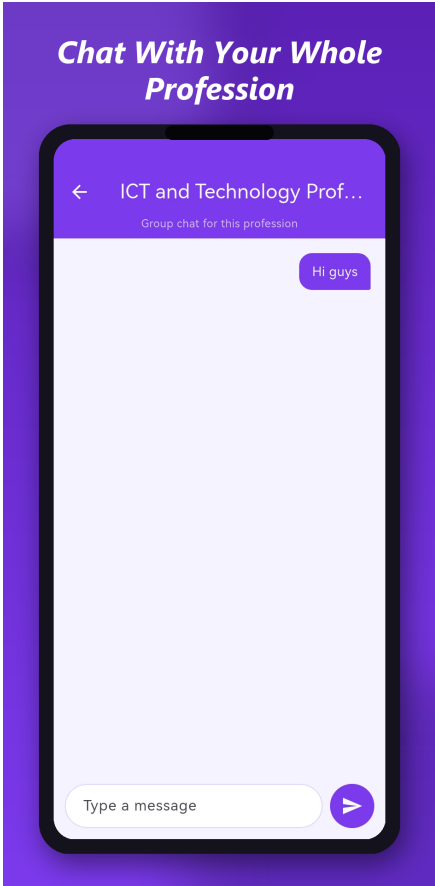
Dashboard — browse professionals by category



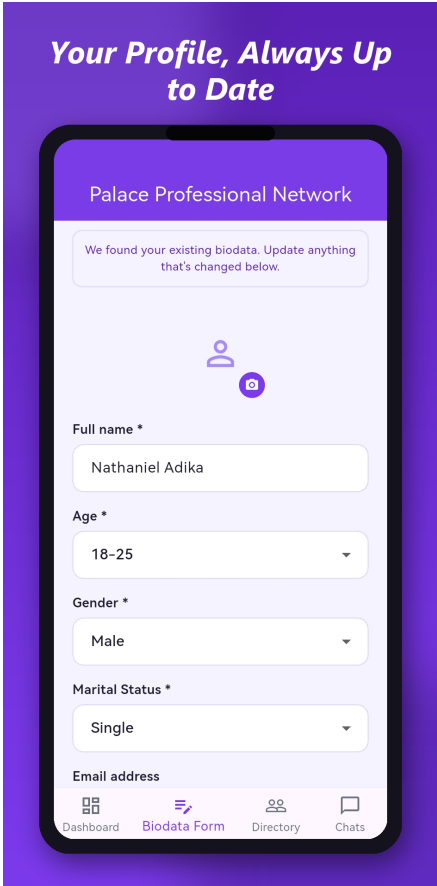
Searchable professional directory



Chats — profession groups and direct messages



Live group chat for each profession



Editable biodata profile, pre-filled on return

How It's Built

PPN is built as a modern, scalable system rather than a single monolithic app, so each part can grow independently as the church community grows.

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Mobile app	Flutter	The primary way members use PPN, on Android (and iOS-ready).
Web app	React	A browser-based version of the platform.
Backend	NestJS (microservices)	Two services — a public gateway and a biodata/data service — communicating internally.
Real-time chat	WebSockets (Socket.IO)	Instant message delivery for direct and group chats.
Database	MongoDB Atlas	Cloud-hosted, stores member profiles, accounts, and chat history.
Hosting	Fly.io	Runs the backend in production, reachable worldwide.

Security & Privacy

- **Encrypted in transit** — all traffic between the app and the server uses HTTPS/WSS.
- **PINs are hashed** — login PINs are never stored in plain text, only as one-way bcrypt hashes.
- **Private by default** — member profiles and messages are only visible to other logged-in members, never public on the internet.

Current Status

- **Live in production** — the backend is deployed and running on Fly.io.
- **115 real members imported** — the full current church professional membership is already in the system.
- **Google Play submission in progress** — the app has been through closed testing, with a signed release ready for the Play Store.
- **Legal & policy documents in place** — a Privacy Policy and data-deletion process are published, as required for app store approval.

What's Next

- **Public launch** — moving from closed testing to a full production release on the Google Play Store.
- **Member onboarding** — helping the existing 115 members log in for the first time and set their own PIN.
- **Ongoing improvements** — refining the directory, chat, and profile experience based on real member feedback after launch.

This document summarizes the Palace Professional Network project for the purpose of preparing a presentation. For questions, contact the project team at International Palace Church.